

# Personal trading plan

Discretionary — running on the algorithm's rails

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I trade the setups by hand, because the evidence says my context read beats the machine's filter. But I run on the algorithm's rails for everything the machine does better than me: **sizing, stops, exits, and stopping.**

The split, stated once so I don't forget it.

My edge is **SELECTION** — picking which of the day's setups is the real one.

The machine's edge is **DISCIPLINE** — executing without mood.

The worst version of me reads the context right and gives it back through size, revenge, or skipping the boring ones.

Live from R1,000 · Exness ZAR · GBPUSD, EURUSD, NZDUSD · max 1 trade per pair, 3 per day

Every figure in this plan is read from the live engine config at build time, so the plan cannot drift from the algorithm.

# The five rules

This page is the whole plan. Everything after it is the detail behind it.

1

## I trade only what is on the card.

If the setup does not tick the card, there is no trade — no matter how it looks, how long I have waited, or what I missed yesterday. **“Nothing today” is a result, not a failure.** Outside the killzone there is no trade. Past my daily cap there is no trade.

*Because the machine is never bored, and I am.*

2

## Size comes from the table. Never from the feeling.

Base lot is whatever my equity tier says. I may apply **one** 1.25× step, and only for a named confirmation from the list. Nothing else changes my size — not conviction, not a streak, not making back yesterday. Risk never exceeds **8%** on one trade.

*Because sizing on feeling is the fastest way to give back an edge — and the record says that feeling is mostly not informative.*

3

## Stop and target are set before I enter, and I do not renegotiate them.

Stop beyond the intermediate swing, capped at **10 pips**. Target is the nearest qualifying draw at **30 pips** or more. I trail on the ladder. **I take the whole position off at the draw** — the continuation afterwards is a new trade with a new entry, not a reason to hold.

*Because every single exit modification tested lost money: –49%, –75%, and one version bankrupted the test account.*

4

## I add only on the pyramid conditions. I never add to rescue.

An add requires **+15 pips already in profit**, at least 30 pips of target still remaining, and the higher timeframe still agreeing. Maximum **3 legs**. **If the trade is against me, there is no add. Ever.** That is averaging down wearing a pyramid's clothes.

*Because the two look identical in the moment and opposite on the account.*

5

## The breakers are mine and they are not negotiable.

**2 stop-outs, or –6% on the day → I am done for the day.** 5 losses in a row → done. –10% from session open → flat, day over. –15% from my equity peak → **10 calendar days off. Never a new trade in the same dollar direction as one that just stopped out.**

*Because revenge and tilt are the only things that can actually end the account — and blocking correlated exposure alone lifted profit factor from 2.47 to 2.98 in testing.*

# The detail

## When I trade

|                    |                                                          |
|--------------------|----------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Pairs</b>       | GBPUSD, EURUSD, NZDUSD — nothing else                    |
| <b>London Open</b> | 03:00 – 05:00 New York time                              |
| <b>New York AM</b> | 07:00 – 10:00 New York time                              |
| <b>NZDUSD</b>      | London Open only — NY AM was a confirmed drain           |
| <b>Hard block</b>  | No new entry in the last <b>15 minutes</b> of a killzone |
| <b>Daily cap</b>   | <b>1 trade per pair, 3 total</b> , per day               |

The cap is part of Rule 1. Three is the ceiling, not the target — most days should be one or zero.

## The setup card — Rule 1

Every box must tick before I click. No partial cards.

### Direction and pair

- Dollar direction is clear (not flat) on H1 structure
- The pair is the one the dollar and EURGBP select
- **Golden rule:** short is GBPUSD, long is EURUSD — unless the cross says otherwise

### Structure

- There is a consolidation / dealing range I can point at
- One side was swept and price closed **back inside** (the Judas)
- I am entering on a PD array — gap, order block or breaker — on the **retrace**, not the sweep leg

### Quality — I want at least TWO of these four

- The sweep ran **yesterday's high or low** (55% / 53% vs 45% baseline, 115 trades)
- The **H4 candle already swept and rejected** (50.4% win rate, 137 trades)
- My entry sits at an HTF gap's midpoint
- It is **Monday or Tuesday of NFP week** (62.5% / 52.1%)

### Target

- At least **three different** sources agree at my target, within ~8 pips (*one source: PF 0.02 · two: 0.20 · three: 6.70*)
- Target is  $\geq 30$  pips away and  $\geq 1.2\times$  my stop
- It is the **nearest** qualifying draw — I am not reaching past it

### Nothing in the way

- No opposing HTF gap sitting between my entry and my target
- No high-impact news in the window
- I hold no open position in the same dollar direction

If fewer than two quality boxes tick, or the target needs fewer than three sources — there is no trade. That is the card doing its job.

## Size — Rule 2 in numbers

| Account equity  | Lot         | Per pip | 10-pip stop | 30-pip target |
|-----------------|-------------|---------|-------------|---------------|
| R1,000 – R3,000 | <b>0.02</b> | R3.70   | –R37        | +R111         |
| R3,000 – R6,000 | <b>0.05</b> | R9.25   | –R92        | +R278         |
| R6,000+         | <b>0.09</b> | R16.65  | –R167       | +R500         |

The **1.25× step** — one only, and only for one of these:

- the sweep ran prior-day high/low
- H4 turtle soup already fired my way
- four or more sources agree at the target
- the trade follows the golden rule
- entry is at an HTF gap's midpoint

**Below R3,000 there is no step at all.** The multipliers are disabled under R3,000 in the engine and they are disabled for me too.

■ ■ The account **cannot** size below 0.02 lots. If I draw under R1,000 the tier table says 0.01 but the broker floor is 0.02 — so my worst day is about **R74 (two stops)**, not the R55 figure in the old notes. The –6% daily cap is what actually contains it.

## Exit — Rule 3 in numbers

| Trade progress  | Where my stop goes                                      |
|-----------------|---------------------------------------------------------|
| Entry           | Beyond the intermediate swing, <b>capped at 10 pips</b> |
| <b>+10 pips</b> | Breakeven                                               |
| <b>+20 pips</b> | Entry <b>+10</b>                                        |
| <b>+40 pips</b> | Entry <b>+35</b>                                        |
| <b>+60 pips</b> | Entry <b>+55</b>                                        |
| every +20 after | lock ( <b>milestone – 5</b> )                           |

**Target: the nearest qualifying draw, 30 pips minimum.** Aim at the **3-day pool** — reached 58% and 61% of the time. The 30-day and 60-day pools are reached about one time in five; they are extensions, not objectives.

**At the draw I am flat.** No trailing past it, no half-position running on.

## Pyramiding — Rule 4 in numbers

An add is permitted only when **all four** are true:

| # | Condition                                                                                |
|---|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 1 | Price is <b>≥ 15 pips</b> in profit on the existing position                             |
| 2 | <b>≥ 30 pips</b> of target still remains                                                 |
| 3 | The dollar still agrees <b>and</b> at least one higher timeframe still confirms the draw |
| 4 | I am on leg 1 or 2 — <b>maximum 3 legs</b> , each the same size                          |

Each leg carries its **own** stop, placed structurally, capped at 10 pips.

**An add is never a rescue.** If the trade is against me the answer is no. There is no version of this rule where being underwater permits another entry.

## The breakers — Rule 5 in numbers

| Trigger                         | Action                                                    |
|---------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------|
| –6% of the day's opening equity | No new entries for the rest of the day                    |
| 2 stop-outs in a day            | Same — I close the laptop                                 |
| 5 losses in a row               | Done for the day                                          |
| –10% from session open          | Close everything, day over                                |
| –15% from equity peak           | <b>10 calendar days off.</b> No exceptions, no “just one” |
| Just stopped out                | <b>No new trade in that same dollar direction</b>         |

**On that last one:** EURUSD, GBPUSD and NZDUSD are one dollar bet wearing three names. A long EURUSD and a short GBPUSD is the same position twice, with two spreads. Blocking that is measured to be worth roughly half a point of profit factor.

# The routine

## Before the session — 15 minutes

| # | Step                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                    |
|---|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 1 | <b>Mark the daily gaps.</b> Nearest unfilled daily gap above and below price, per pair, and how far each is. A daily gap fills 90–96% of the time over a median 5–9 days — this is my map of where price is likely to travel, <b>not</b> a direction signal on its own. |
| 2 | <b>Read the dollar.</b> H1 structure as of yesterday's close — the previous day's price action tells the story.                                                                                                                                                         |
| 3 | <b>Read the cross.</b> EURGBP decides which of EUR/GBP to trade. The counters say the cross does more filtering work than the dollar.                                                                                                                                   |
| 4 | <b>Mark the range.</b> Yesterday's high/low, the Asian range, the previous session's high/low.                                                                                                                                                                          |
| 5 | <b>Check the calendar.</b> High-impact news in the window = no trade.                                                                                                                                                                                                   |
| 6 | <b>Write down what I expect</b> — one sentence, before price moves. This is how I find out later whether I read it right or told myself a story afterwards.                                                                                                             |

## During the session

- Watch for the card. Do not hunt for it.
- 1 trade per pair. 3 total. Then stop looking.
- When it triggers: enter, set stop, set target, **walk away from the chart**.
- Manage only at the ladder levels. Nothing between them needs me.

## After the session — 10 minutes

Log every trade. The five fields that matter:

| Field                                                  | Why                                            |
|--------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------|
| Which quality boxes ticked                             | Builds the live version of the evidence tables |
| <b>Toward or away from the daily gap</b> , and how far | The one live open question — see below         |
| Did I follow all five rules? <b>Yes / No</b>           | This is the real score                         |
| If no — which one, and what was I feeling              | The pattern is the point                       |
| Outcome in <b>R</b> , not rands                        | Rands make small accounts feel like failures   |

**Rule-following is scored separately from profit.** A losing trade that followed all five rules is a **good** trade. A winning trade that broke one is a **bad** trade that happened to pay — and that is the one that teaches the worst habit.

## The one thing I am still collecting data on

Trades pointing **at** an unfilled daily gap won more often in both halves of the backtest — **+5.1 and +4.2 points**. Right sign, right size, twice over, which very little in this project managed. It could not be *proven* because it needs roughly four times the data we have.

So I note it, and I do **not** force trades around it. After a few months of live trades I will have something nobody had before: a real record of whether the toward-the-gap setups are my signature moves.

# When I break a rule

It will happen. What matters is what happens next.

| # |                                                                                                                                                                      |
|---|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 1 | <b>Write it down the same day</b> — which rule, what I was feeling, what it cost.                                                                                    |
| 2 | <b>No make-back trade.</b> The rule was broken; adding a second break does not repair the first.                                                                     |
| 3 | <b>Two breaks in a week → one full week on demo.</b> Not as punishment — because two breaks means the rules are not yet automatic, and automatic is the whole point. |

## Review

| When         | What I look at                                                                                                                                                                                                    |
|--------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Weekly       | Rule-following score. Not P&L. <b>The score.</b>                                                                                                                                                                  |
| Monthly      | My live win rate and profit factor against the algorithm's <b>43.9%</b> and <b>4.01</b> . If I am below it after 50+ trades, the honest answer is the machine should be running this and I should be supervising. |
| At 50 trades | Re-run the analysis on my own trade log — which of my quality boxes actually predicted anything, tested the same way the algorithm was: controls, and both halves.                                                |

Baseline to measure myself against: the algorithm produced **736 trades** over 2022–2025 — win rate **43.9%**, profit factor **4.01**, worst drawdown **–13.24%**, turning R1,000 into R132,020 withdrawn plus R8,555 working capital.